

Certification Exam Day Checklist

For the PMP and most computer-based professional exams, online or at a test centre. The official rules in your exam body's handbook and appointment confirmation always take precedence. Full guide: [PMP exam day checklist](#).

One week before

- ☐ Appointment confirmed: date, time zone, online or test centre.
- ☐ ID name matches the registration exactly as the rules require.
- ☐ Candidate rules read: permitted items, breaks, lateness, rescheduling.
- ☐ **Online:** official system test passed on the same computer, network and room.
- ☐ **Online:** room private and quiet, desk clear, updates and notifications off.
- ☐ **Test centre:** route, travel time and arrival time planned.
- ☐ Final full mock taken early in the week, not the day before.

The night before

- ☐ ID and permitted items laid out.
- ☐ **Online:** computer restarted, system test run again.
- ☐ **Test centre:** travel updates checked, two alarms set.
- ☐ 30–45 minutes of light review, then stop.
- ☐ Normal meal, normal bedtime.

The morning

- ☐ Familiar meal; water.
- ☐ Log in or arrive early for check-in.
- ☐ 10 minutes writing down worries, then put the paper away.
- ☐ Three slow breaths: "This is my body getting ready."

Pacing worksheet

Use the official total time and number of questions from your appointment details. Rehearse these checkpoints in at least two full mocks.

Section	Time	Questions	Reserve	Target per question	$\frac{1}{4}$ checkpoint	$\frac{1}{2}$ checkpoint	$\frac{3}{4}$ checkpoint

My flag-and-move rule: if I have no clear answer after about _____ seconds, I eliminate what I can, choose the best remaining option, flag it and move on. I return to flags before the section ends (check whether review is allowed after breaks).

During the exam

- Read the final sentence first: *first, next, best, most likely?*
- Identify the context: approach, phase, who is involved.
- Look at the clock only at checkpoints.
- A run of hard questions is normal — it does not mean you are failing.
- Use permitted breaks: stand, stretch, drink water, one breathing reset.

60-second reset — when panic rises: eyes off the screen · breathe in for about 4 seconds · breathe out for about 6 seconds · repeat 3–5 times · relax shoulders and jaw · read only the last sentence of the question first.

If something goes wrong

- **Online technical issue:** use the proctor chat or follow the provider's instructions; stay in camera view unless told otherwise.
- **Test centre disruption:** raise your hand and tell the administrator.
- **Feeling unwell before the exam:** check the official rescheduling rules early.

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